



State Employment
Leadership Network

Monthly Network Meeting

May 18, 2016

SELN Monthly Network Meeting: May 18, 2016

AGENDA

Welcome to everyone!

- Brief intros
- Housekeeping

Discussion

Supporting Families in an Age of Competing Demands

Project Business

- Community Life Engagement project
- Recent SELN publications, upcoming meetings and focused dialogue with colleagues – check the Hub!
- Hub update (www.selnhub.org)

Conferences/Meetings

- [National APSE conference](#), June 21-24, Cincinnati, OH
- [Reinventing Quality](#), July 31 – August 2, Baltimore, MD
- SELN annual meeting, October 4-6, Alexandria, VA



Discussion

Supporting Families in an Age
of Competing Demands





Today’s Goals

- Inform: Gathering feedback and responding
- Build Awareness: Variety in current activities around the country
- Promote Discussion: Connecting with this work beyond today’s meeting



Who you will hear from today

- Nancy Nickolaus
- Allison Hall
- John Kramer
- Jen Sulewski

Hosts:
Suzzanne Freeze
Rie Kennedy Lizotte



Nancy Nickolaus
SELN Project Team



SELN Related Work



Discussions



Survey



Special Series

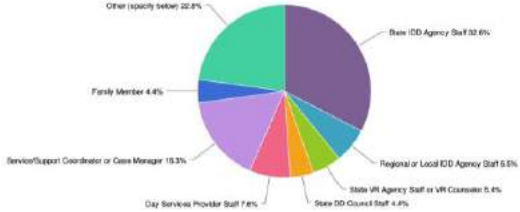


2015 SELN Survey to Members

- Target Audience: state I/DD agencies and partners.
 - What are you doing?
 - Is it working? How do you know?
 - Challenges



Roles of the 92 Respondents



Role	Percentage
Base I/DD Agency Staff	32.6%
Regional or Local I/DD Agency Staff	5.5%
State VR Agency Staff or VR Counselors	5.4%
State I/DD Council Staff	4.3%
Day Services Provider Staff	7.6%
Service/Support Coordinator or Case Manager	15.3%
Family Member	4.4%
Other (specifically listed)	22.8%



Survey Results

- Family Involvement
- Case Management
- Barriers
- Family Training
- Communication and Messaging
- Ages Targeted
- Tracking Family Engagement Success

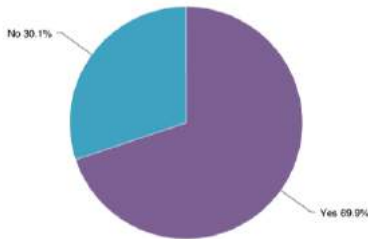


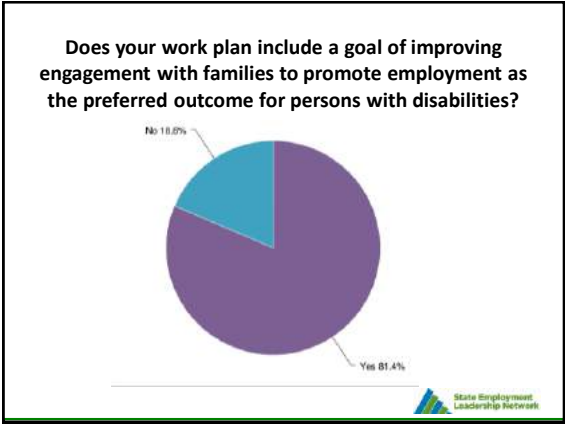
What We Have Learned

- Ensure Staff Understand the “WHY”
- Prepare Staff to be Responsive
- Support Families to Make Connections



Does your state have a current work plan to improve integrated employment outcomes?





Allison Hall and John Kramer
SELN project team and RRTC project team

State Employment Leadership Network

Family Employment Systems
Interaction Study
John Kramer

Rehabilitation Research and Training Center on Advancing Employment
for Individuals with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities

A project of

ThinkWork! **ICI** **UMASS BOSTON**

at the Institute for Community Inclusion, UMass Boston

Individuals and families

- Our Approach
- ❖ Scoping Literature
 - ❖ Online/In-person Focus Groups



Examples of engagement strategies

- Trainings to inform families and teach them to advocate:
 - Explore, Prepare, Act
 - Let’s Get to Work
 - FEAT
 - Computer-based instruction
- Is training the only approach?



Gaps and need

- Outreach to families from diverse communities, with the help of community liaisons
- Earlier engagement with families of young children/sustained engagement with older families
- The use of social media to educate and connect families
- Community conversations to increase inclusion and employment opportunities
- Effects of positive role modeling? Portrayal of people with disabilities in work, etc.



Findings...so far

- Family engagement is not effective when its late
- Family v. service – working against, not with each other
- Beliefs about employment are not uniform across providers...confusing for families
- Forward movement happens sometimes when families give up on engaging services
- IEP process – lack of clear employment goals
- Fear of disclosure and discrimination (Self-Advocates)



Questions for the group

- We’re going to test a strategy for engaging families
- Training and just-in-time approaches
- Wildly differing views...
 - Families say it is a system that doesn’t provide good employment support
 - Self-advocates say it is discrimination by employers
 - Systems say families are too protective
- Can we reconcile this by improving communication?
- How might we do that?



Two ideas for your consideration

- Existing planning tools – model an employment specific engagement strategy
 - Target information in ways that are specific to where the person is at
 - <https://futureplanning.thearc.org/>
- Peer to peer approach
 - Existing efforts
 - Online/virtual approach/real world engagement using “light touch” or micro-engagements...
- Do you know of existing efforts that have worked well?



Rie Kennedy-Lizotte
SELN Project Team



SELN members and NASDDDS' Supporting Families Initiative
("community of practice") states



Discussion



Meeting Follow up and Materials

- Is your state addressing similar themes
 - Make available planning tools that are person-centered, flexible, family-friendly, and accessible
 - Prepare staff to recognize and respond to opportunities to promote pro-employment values and provide messaging tools
- Where more attention is needed
- Visit the SELN Hub to access resources and learn from colleagues (www.selnhub.org)



Hub Orientation Sessions

- Wednesday, May 25
 - 11am and 3pm ET
- Friday, May 27
 - 10am ET
- Wednesday, June 1
 - 11am and 3pm ET
- Thursday, June 2
 - 11am and 3pm ET
- Friday, June 3
 - 10am and 1pm ET
- By appointment



Jen Sulewski
SELN Project Team



Community Life Engagement

Toolkit Pilot Testing



What is Community Life Engagement?

- Community Life Engagement (CLE) refers to supporting people with IDD to access and participate in their communities outside of employment as part of a meaningful day
- Volunteer work
- Postsecondary / adult / continuing education
- Accessing gyms / libraries / recreation centers
- Retirement activities



CLE Case Studies

- 3 providers chosen from an initial list of 38 nominees based on a number of factors including: number of individuals served, geographic location, and quality of CLE services currently being provided
- 2-day site visits conducted at each provider during the summer of 2015
- 51 total individuals interviewed:
 - 23 provider staff members
 - 7 community partners
 - 16 individuals with IDD
 - 5 family members of individuals



CLE Guideposts for Success

- Individualize supports for each person
- Promote Community membership and Contribution
- Use Human and Social Capital to Decrease Dependence on Paid Supports
- Ensure supports are Outcome-Oriented and Regularly Monitored



Future -Toolkit Pilot Testing

- 2-3 states selected from application process based on their level of interest in expanding and/or improving CLE supports in their state and their level of investment in the systems change process
- States will have several interested providers in mind
- Each “site” (state agency + providers) will use the toolkit over 8 months
- Each site will receive an introduction to the toolkit, monthly TA calls, and 2 site visits to collect baseline, progress, and satisfaction data



Benefits to Participation

- Be one of the first states to use a Community Life Engagement toolkit
- Offer your state providers opportunities to learn strategies to individualize supports, access community partners, and sequence funds
- Be a leader in systems change!



We hope you decide to participate!

Access the application link online:
www.surveymoz.com/s3/2739098/CLE-State-Application

For more information on Community Life
Engagement:
<http://www.thinkwork.org/community-life-engagement>

Thank you for your time



Resource to Watch

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) for
Pre-Employment Transition Services (PETS)
on the RSA website:

<http://www.ed.gov/programs/rsabvrs/fiscal-resources/index.html#faq>



Upcoming events for the calendar:

- Data Users’ group meeting – June 14th @ 3 pm ET, 60 mins
- Monthly network meetings
9am HT/ 12pm PT/ 1pm MT/ 2pm CT/ 3pm ET (90 minutes)
 - 2015-2016 membership year
 - June 15th
 - 2016-2017 membership year
 - July 20th
 - September 21st
- SELN Annual Meeting, October 4-6 at the Hilton Old Town in Alexandria, VA